SPACE-CAP

A digital memory vessel that brings university friends together to **collect, preserve, and cherish the memories** of their shared university journey.



TEAM 12: NO PARKING

DOMIAN: SUPPORTING RELATIONSHIPS THROUGH NOSTALGIA AND REMINISCENCE

01. THE GAP

Memories are made together, but kept apart.

VOICE NOTES · PHYSICAL & DIGITAL BELONGINGS · DIGITAL STORAGE · PASSIVE WATCHING

In our interviews, memories were made together but kept apart: on people's own phones, in their own boxes, or brought back by algorithms. Beyond the interviews, we see each other's lives through feeds without sharing them. What's missing is remembering together.

REFERENCES INTERVIWES, OBSERVATIONS AND READINGS

02. SOCIAL AND MOBILE

Mutual Reminiscence

SOCIAL		MOBILE
A GROUP OF FRIENDS		ACROSS TIME AND PLACE
MADE TOGETHER, KEPT TOGETHER	SPACE CAP	ADDED FROM WHEREVER LIFE GOES
OPENS ONLY WHEN ALL TAKE PART		BRINGS EVERYONE BACK TO ONE PLACE
COLLECT		UNLOCK

Mutual reminiscence is remembering together, over time. As technology has grown, we've become passively connected. We see more of each other's lives, but we share less. Space-cap gives a group of friends one place to keep their memories, and a reason to come back together.

ASYNCHRONOUS WHILE COLLECTING ⇅ SYNCHRONOUS AT THE UNLOCK

At this exhibition: the prototype compresses this longer experience into a short, shared game played across computers.

7 interviews, ages early 20s to 60+ · **10** participants in our thematic analysis · **3** rounds of user testing with real friend group

03. GROUNDED IN RESEARCH

GRUNDIN 1994

Shared effort

Groupware fails when efforts fall evenly on all members

SOLUTION

Everyone adds 3+ memories before launch

OLSSON ET AL. (2020, P. 58)

Shared control

Asymmetric roles make cooperation necessary

SOLUTION

Each player is assigned a different ship control

PETRELLI ET AL. (2009)

Rediscovery

The value is in revisiting and not just keeping/ preserving.

SOLUTION

The capsule opens through a shared game.

Design response: The capsule opens through a shared game, turning retrieval into an activity the group experiences together.

04. WHO IS IT FOR

Final year friends : closest now scattered soon



Together now
The last semester, when memories are being made every day



Apart soon
New jobs, new cities, often new countries. especially for international students

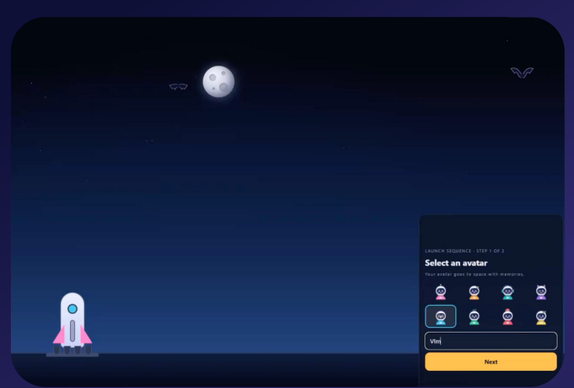


Reunited later
Graduations, weddings, first job, a move home, milestones that bring friends back

05. THE EXPERIENCE

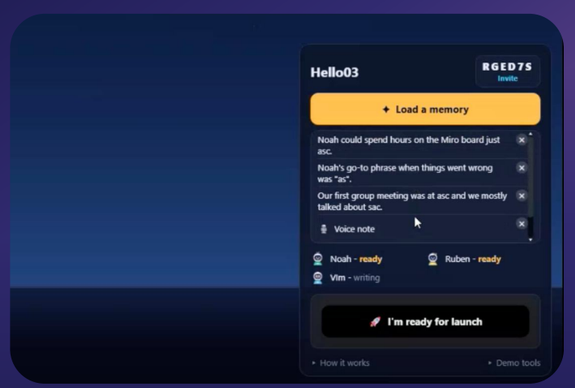
Collect. Keep. Fly together. Reveal

1 COLLECT



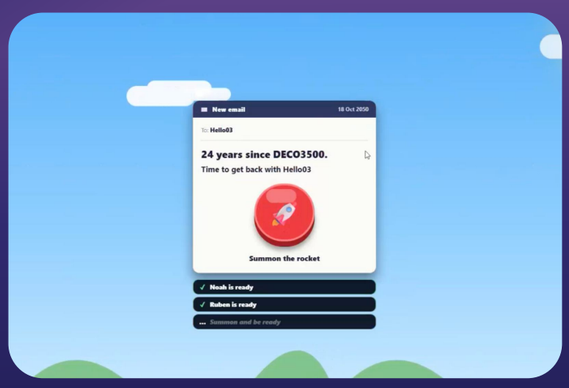
Pick an astronaut and join your crew.

2 KEEP



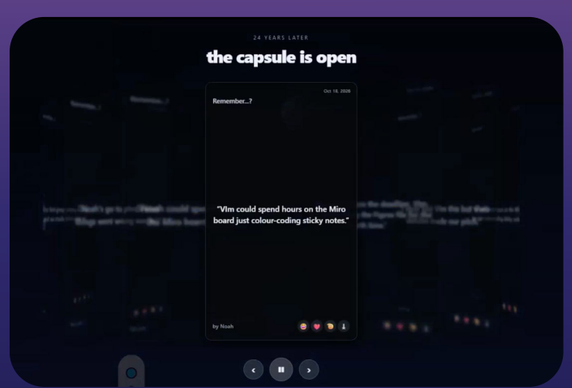
When everyone taps ready, the rocket launches the sealed capsule.

3 FLY TOGETHER



Years later the crew reunites to fly one ship with shared controls.

4 REVEAL



The capsule opens on a memory wall.

06. HOW WE GOT HERE

Each test over the week's introduced new updates

FIRST BUILD

We saw: participants wrote about themselves, and a host screen created one person as leader

We updated: prompts that asked for a crewmate, added a brief clip,removed the host, and memory collection changed to the entire semester

Friend groups are peers, not a different hierarchy based class

GAME A/B TEST

We saw: own ships feel like playing alone. Social connection happen over split controls. Colour game caused confusions

We updated: shared controls as the core game for one space craft, and limited the primary activity to 1.

Needing each other starts the conversation.

FULL FLOW TEST

We saw: players were not aware who has which control and memory submission didn't have voice commands or live-camera pic.

We updated: who holds each control, allow people with more media upload option

Collaboration has to be visible to happen and flexible.

Design response: The rocket launch, reunite event, shooting game to recollect memories, and experience the submissions.

07. ETHICS AND OPEN QUESTIONS

Consent
Needed of all the people who are in common pictures

Anonymity
Easier to share, harder to hold accountable for. Optional, not the default.

Will it last?
With technological advancements will it still exist in 2050.

Who's missing
If someone is not able to attend or is no longer a part of the group, unlock needs another path